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TALKING BUSINESS US vice president J.D. Vance with PM Narendra Modi in New Delhi, Apr. 21

INDIA-US RELATIONS

GOING BEYOND TRADE TIES

By Pradip R. Sagar

Cynics could say the surround sound wasn't too auspicious. Within a day of his touchdown, US Vice President J.D. Vance had the mortification of seeing his India visit being cited in the same breath as a tragedy in Kashmir. Correlation, not causation, was a maxim already in play—sorrow had enveloped the Vatican soon after a pit-stop by the veep en route to India. Not to speak of the grief his boss had given to the world economy, the only one that could be directly addressed to Vance, and which he was prepared to answer for. "We're not here to preach that you do things a certain way," he said in the only public engagement of his four-day visit, at the Rajasthan International Centre in Jaipur, on April 22. "We come to you as partners, looking to strengthen our relationship."